

Roles and Responsibilities

Organisation for the US soft and full launch (early 2027) · Draft for review · 28 September 2026

This document has one page for each role in Kind's launch organisation. It reflects the decisions agreed between Ben Fehnert and Prof Glyn Elwyn, the IRB brief of 21 August 2026 and the interim BRANY answers of 7 September 2026. Items marked **Proposed** are drafts not yet agreed; items marked **Open** need a decision.

Role	Holder	Reports / accountable to
BOARD OF DIRECTORS		
01 Independent Director or Chair (future)	To be appointed	The Board of Directors and stockholders
02 Chief Executive Officer	Ben Fehnert	The Board of Directors
03 Chief Science Officer	Prof Glyn Elwyn, Dartmouth Institute	CEO
04 Outside Board Member (future)	To be confirmed	The Board of Directors and stockholders
05 Secretary	To be appointed	The Board of Directors
MANAGEMENT TEAM		
06 Head of Operations	David Haddad	CEO
07 Head of Science	To be recruited (interim: Prof Glyn Elwyn)	CEO, with a dotted line to the CSO
08 Head of Product	Grady Ng	CEO
09 Head of Growth	To be recruited	CEO
COMPLIANCE		
10 Data Protection Officer / Privacy Officer	Vacant	Head of Operations
11 Safety Officer	Vacant	Head of Operations
SCIENCE GOVERNANCE		
12 Investigator of Record	Prof Glyn Elwyn	BRANY (IRB)
13 Science Advisory Board Chair	Rolling chair, from Science Advisory Board members	CSO and Board of Directors
14 Science Advisory Board Member	Prof Chris Schmid; Prof Sunita Vohra; Prof Rich Kravitz; Prof Glyn Elwyn	CSO and Board of Directors
15 Protocol Review Board: Non-scientist Member	To be confirmed	Protocol Review Board (voting)
16 Protocol Review Board: Unaffiliated Member	To be confirmed	Protocol Review Board (voting)

Independent Director or Chair (future)

An independent seat on the Board of Directors, added once Kind raises institutional funding, to bring independent oversight and, if the Board chooses, to chair it.

Holder	To be appointed, after institutional funding
Board / team	Board of Directors
Reports to	The Board of Directors and stockholders
Receives	The DPO's direct line, as part of the Board of Directors

Key responsibilities

- Provides independent oversight and challenge on strategy, finance, risk and governance
- If appointed Chair, chairs Board meetings and sets the agenda with the CEO
- Oversees the CEO's performance and objectives, with the rest of the Board
- Oversees governance, including the health of the Protocol Review Board and Compliance functions
- Receives data protection and security concerns raised directly by the DPO, as part of the Board
- Supports fundraising and senior strategic relationships

Decision rights

- Votes on Board decisions as set out in Kind's certificate of incorporation, bylaws and investment agreements
- If appointed Chair, runs Board meetings and decision-making

Works closely with

- CEO and other directors, including any investor director
- DPO: direct escalation route
- Secretary: Board meetings, minutes and records

Notes and open points

- Not required at launch. A Delaware C corporation must have a board of directors (which can be a single director) but does not need a chair. At seed stage the founder-CEO usually runs Board meetings.
- Once appointed, this director is the natural first contact for concerns the DPO raises through the direct line.
- **Proposed:** timing, and whether this seat also chairs the Board, to be agreed with investors.

Chief Executive Officer

Leads Kind, sets company strategy and is accountable to the Board of Directors for delivery, funding and culture.

Holder	Ben Fehnert (MA, Experimental Psychology)
Board / team	Board of Directors (director and officer); leads the Management Team
Reports to	The Board of Directors
Direct reports	Chief Science Officer, Head of Operations, Head of Science, Head of Product, Head of Growth

Key responsibilities

- Sets and delivers the company strategy, plan and budget with the Management Team
- Leads fundraising and investor relations
- Builds and leads the Management Team, including the hires still to make
- Makes sure the governance functions (Science Advisory Board, Protocol Review Board, Compliance) are resourced and work as designed
- Represents Kind to partners, researchers and the IRB alongside the CSO
- Keeps the Board informed, including of any concerns the DPO escalates directly to it
- Owns the state-by-state medical licensure review with US counsel (Wiggin and Dana)
- Makes sure Kind's liability insurance and legal advisory cover extend to all active tiers, reviewed at least yearly

Decision rights

- Company strategy, budget and senior appointments, within limits the Board approves
- Product and commercial priorities, with the relevant Heads

Works closely with

- CSO: science strategy and its fit with company strategy
- Board of Directors: accountability for performance
- Secretary: Board meetings, minutes and corporate records

Notes and open points

- The CEO does not approve Health Explorations. That sits with the Protocol Review Board and the IRB, kept separate from product approval.

Chief Science Officer

Owns Kind's science strategy and is the accountable officer for scientific integrity.

Holder	Prof Glyn Elwyn (MD), Dartmouth Institute
Board / team	Management Team; Board of Directors (proposed, not yet agreed)
Reports to	CEO, as a member of the Management Team
Also holds	Interim Head of Science; Chair of the Protocol Review Board; Investigator of record (separate page)
Dotted line from	Head of Science, once hired

Key responsibilities

- Sets the science strategy and evidence roadmap
- Accountable for scientific integrity across all Health Explorations, analyses and publications
- Chairs the Protocol Review Board, handing the chair to the rolling stand-in when he has a conflict of interest
- Acts as investigator of record for the IRB umbrella protocol
- Takes the Science Advisory Board's advice into science strategy
- Acts as interim Head of Science until the role is filled, then oversees science delivery through a dotted line from the Head of Science
- Owns Kind's human-subjects ethics position, applying Common Rule standards now and considering 21 CFR 50 and 56 for Tier 3 later

Decision rights

- Chairs Protocol Review Board decisions, subject to quorum and DPO sign-off
- Sets scientific standards, including the approved exploration templates

Works closely with

- CEO: line manager for the CSO role
- Head of Science: delivery and the day-to-day running of the Protocol Review Board
- Science Advisory Board: advice and specialist input
- Safety Officer: safety data for IRB reporting
- BRANY (IRB): as investigator of record

Notes and open points

- Prof Elwyn currently holds several roles: CSO, interim Head of Science, chair of the Protocol Review Board, investigator of record and Science Advisory Board member. The checks are the elected member in the Head of Science seat on the Protocol Review Board, the rolling stand-in chair (which should exclude him), the unaffiliated member and declarations of interest.
- **Open:** a seat on the Board of Directors for Prof Elwyn is proposed.

Outside Board Member (future)

Brings an outside, investor or independent perspective and constructive challenge to the Board of Directors.

Holder	To be confirmed (investor or similar)
Board / team	Board of Directors
Reports to	The Board of Directors and stockholders
Receives	The DPO's direct line, as part of the Board of Directors

Key responsibilities

- Provides constructive challenge on strategy, finance and risk
- Represents investor interests where appointed by investors
- Supports fundraising, networks and commercial introductions
- Contributes to governance oversight, including concerns escalated by the DPO
- Declares any conflicts of interest to the Board

Decision rights

- Votes on Board decisions as set out in Kind's certificate of incorporation, bylaws and any investment agreements

Works closely with

- CEO and other directors
- Investors

Notes and open points

- Responsibilities follow standard practice and depend on the terms of appointment.

Secretary

The corporate officer who keeps Kind's official records and records the proceedings of the Board of Directors and stockholders, as a Delaware C corporation requires.

Holder	To be appointed
Type	Corporate officer (not a director, unless also appointed to the Board)
Appointed by	The Board of Directors
Supported by	Kind's corporate counsel

Key responsibilities

- Records the minutes of Board of Directors and stockholder meetings, and keeps written consents
- Keeps the corporate records: certificate of incorporation, bylaws, Board resolutions and the stock ledger
- Sends notices of Board and stockholder meetings
- Certifies Board resolutions and attests corporate documents where required
- Keeps the register of directors and officers and, with counsel, the annual Delaware franchise tax report
- Keeps the record of conflict-of-interest declarations made at Board level (proposed)

Decision rights

- Record-keeping authority set by the bylaws and the Board
- No vote on the Board unless also a director

Works closely with

- Board of Directors and CEO
- Corporate counsel
- Head of Operations: company records, contracts and filings

Notes and open points

- Delaware law (DGCL §142) requires the officers named in the bylaws, and that one officer records the proceedings of stockholder and director meetings. This officer is usually titled Secretary. One person may hold more than one office.
- **Open:** confirmation whether the CEO or another officer, with counsel acting as assistant secretary.

Head of Operations

Runs Kind's operations and compliance so the platform operates safely and lawfully.

Holder	David Haddad (MSc, Public Health; Health Policy)
Board / team	Management Team
Reports to	CEO
Leads	Compliance: DPO / Privacy Officer, Safety Officer, Data management

Key responsibilities

- Leads the Compliance function: data protection, data management, safety and compliance
- Line-manages the DPO / Privacy Officer and the Safety Officer (both hires to make)
- Owns the adverse-event pathway operationally, including the contracted clinical triage service
- Receives safety signals handed over from the Product Team's community moderation
- Owns operational policies, including the privacy and data governance policy and breach readiness
- Manages business operations, suppliers and contracts, including Data Use Agreements with research institutions

Decision rights

- Operational policies and suppliers, within the agreed budget

Works closely with

- Head of Product: community-to-safety hand-off
- Head of Growth: marketing and communications in line with product scope
- DPO: line management (the DPO also has a direct line to the Board of Directors, outside this line)
- Safety Officer: adverse events and IRB reporting

Notes and open points

- If elected as the temporary member covering the Head of Science seat on the Protocol Review Board, he would also manage the DPO whose sign-off the board needs. The DPO's direct line to the Board of Directors reduces this conflict.

Head of Science

Owens science delivery and runs the Protocol Review Board day to day.

Holder	To be recruited. Interim: Prof Glyn Elwyn (CSO)
Board / team	Management Team; Protocol Review Board (fixed member)
Reports to	CEO, with a dotted line to the CSO
Leads	Science Team

Key responsibilities

- Leads evidence generation, statistical models and pre-specified analysis plans or explicit emulative analysis
- Leads health literacy, science partnerships with researchers, and publishing (preprints)
- Prepares each new protocol against an approved template for the Protocol Review Board
- Runs Protocol Review Board meetings: agendas, minutes, the disclosure log and quorum checks
- Prepares the documented screening sent to BRANY with each submission
- Maintains the library of approved exploration templates (proposed)
- Runs the documented cycle of review, comments and revision for each protocol against approved templates and N-of-1 and trial reporting standards
- Coordinates the risk assessment for each protocol, including the clinical and user-safety review
- Reviews matching relevance feedback and completion rates periodically; these never change matching scores automatically

Decision rights

- Fixed, voting member of the Protocol Review Board, required for a valid decision

Works closely with

- CSO: dotted line for science strategy and integrity
- Science Advisory Board: specialist input
- Head of Product: building approved protocols into the product
- Head of Growth: marketing and communications in line with product scope
- DPO and Safety Officer: sign-off and safety review

Notes and open points

- Until the role is filled, Prof Glyn Elwyn (CSO) acts as interim Head of Science and leads science delivery.
- **Proposed:** while he is interim, the Head of Science seat on the Protocol Review Board is covered by an elected temporary member (elected by the CEO and agreed with the CSO), so the chair and this seat are held by two different people.

Head of Product

Owns Kind's product end to end. There is no CTO at launch, so this role also owns engineering and security.

Holder	Grady Ng (MSc, Psychology; HCI)
Board / team	Management Team
Reports to	CEO
Leads	Product Team, including engineering and security

Key responsibilities

- Leads the design system, product design, user research and user experience
- Owns engineering and security
- Owns language and editorial across the product
- Owns community features and their moderation
- Hands anything that could be a safety signal from community moderation to Operations (the Safety Officer)
- Builds approved protocols, eligibility filters and consent flows into the product as the IRB approved them
- Builds and maintains the rule-based, deterministic matching engine; any change to rules, tags or weights needs Protocol Review Board approval
- Keeps the audit trail of consent, prompts, confirmations and screening, and enforces the crisis redirect (911/988) and the no-treatment-advice rules in the product

Decision rights

- Product roadmap and technical architecture, with the CEO

Works closely with

- Head of Operations and Safety Officer: community-to-safety hand-off
- Head of Science: exploration templates and analysis
- Head of Growth: marketing and communications in line with product scope
- DPO: privacy by design and security

Notes and open points

- Product and roadmap approval is kept separate from the Protocol Review Board's ethics screen.
- Head of Product attending the Protocol Review Board as a non-voting contributor.

Head of Growth

Grows Kind's community of individuals and researchers and its revenue.

Holder	To be recruited
Board / team	Management Team
Reports to	CEO
Leads	Growth Team

Key responsibilities

- Leads marketing and acquisition of individuals
- Leads sales to researchers and research organisations
- Owns subscriptions, including researcher subscription tiers
- Develops commercial partnerships
- Makes sure marketing never uses health data for advertising and makes no HIPAA compliance claims
- Makes sure Tier 2 and Tier 3 flags (clinician-informed status, prescription data) are never used in advertising or shared with third parties

Decision rights

- Marketing, pricing and partnership proposals, within the agreed plan

Works closely with

- DPO: marketing and data use
- Head of Operations: Data Use Agreements for research customers
- Head of Product: onboarding and conversion
- Head of Science: ensuring Kind science is correctly represented in any external communications

Notes and open points

- Research consent is kept separate from product consent, so growth tactics must not bundle the two.

Data Protection Officer / Privacy Officer

The accountable officer for data governance, with an independent route to the executive so concerns can be raised without a conflict of interest.

Holder	Vacant (hire to make)
Board / team	Compliance
Reports to	Head of Operations
Direct line to	The Board of Directors

Key responsibilities

- Owns the privacy and data governance policy: retention, security, breach and personal health records
- Signs off every protocol at the Protocol Review Board for data protection and security
- Oversees consent records and withdrawal requests
- Applies the de-identification standard (HIPAA Safe Harbor, as a working definition) and minimum cohort sizes
- Oversees Data Use Agreements for researcher access
- Leads breach assessment, including FTC Health Breach Notification Rule duties (60-day clock)
- Works with counsel on state health privacy laws and the future UK/EU GDPR workstream

Decision rights

- Can withhold sign-off on any protocol
- Can escalate directly to the Board of Directors

Works closely with

- Protocol Review Board
- Head of Product: security and privacy by design
- Head of Growth: marketing and data use
- Head of Science: data protection in line with protocol and ethics agreements

Safety Officer

The accountable officer for adverse events and regulatory monitoring.

Holder	Vacant (hire to make)
Board / team	Compliance
Reports to	Head of Operations
Works with	Investigator of record (CSO) on IRB safety reporting

Key responsibilities

- Runs the adverse-event pathway: detection, severity triage, the independent clinical triage service, and aggregate review of each exploration
- Proposes and monitors pause triggers for each exploration
- Reports unanticipated problems to the IRB through the investigator of record, within the agreed window (proposed: 5–10 business days)
- Receives safety signals handed over from community moderation
- Contributes to the Protocol Review Board's clinical and user-safety review
- Maintains the list of anticipated effects for each exploration, agreed with the Protocol Review Board and IRB
- Monitors exploration content and matching for drift toward disease-specific or treatment claims
- Owns the FDA scope review against General Wellness and Clinical Decision Support guidance, including re-review when intended use, explorations or matching logic change

Decision rights

- Can recommend pausing an exploration when a trigger is met

Works closely with

- Investigator of record
- Head of Product: community signals
- Head of Science: safety in line with protocol and ethics agreements
- Clinical triage service provider

Notes and open points

- Kept distinct from the investigator of record, as the IRB is likely to expect.

Investigator of Record

The named person accountable to the IRB for the conduct and safety of research run under Kind's umbrella protocol.

Holder	Prof Glyn Elwyn (CSO)
Scope	The IRB umbrella protocol and its sub-studies
Accountable to	BRANY (IRB)
Works with	Safety Officer, Head of Science, DPO

Key responsibilities

- Signs IRB submissions for the umbrella protocol and each modification
- Accountable for research being run as the IRB approved it, including consent
- Receives safety data from the Safety Officer and makes sure it is reported to the IRB on time
- Decides, with the Safety Officer, whether to pause an exploration (proposed)
- Cooperates with IRB audits of sub-studies

Decision rights

- Can stop or pause research under the umbrella protocol on safety or integrity grounds

Works closely with

- BRANY
- Safety Officer
- Protocol Review Board

Notes and open points

- Held by the CSO alongside chairing the Protocol Review Board. It is kept distinct from the corporate Safety Officer role.

Science Advisory Board Chair

Leads the Science Advisory Board for a term. The Board is advisory, not operational.

Holder	Rolling chair, from Science Advisory Board members
Board / team	Science Advisory Board
Advises	CSO and Board of Directors
Term	To be agreed

Key responsibilities

- Sets the agenda with the CSO (proposed)
- Chairs meetings and makes sure advice is clear and minuted
- Invites additional advisors depending on the agenda
- Makes sure members declare their interests at each meeting
- Passes the Board's advice to the CSO

Decision rights

- Sets the Board's agenda and invites advisors. The Board gives advice; it does not take operational decisions.

Works closely with

- CSO
- Science Advisory Board members and invited advisors

Science Advisory Board Member

Gives specialist scientific advice in a named area. The role is advisory, not operational.

Current members	Prof Chris Schmid (Bayesian analysis); Prof Sunita Vohra (Methodology); Prof Rich Kravitz; TBD (Emulative trials); Prof Glyn Elwyn (Decision support)
To confirm	Inferential analysis; Communications
Board / team	Science Advisory Board
Advises	CSO and Board of Directors

Key responsibilities

- Advises on science strategy, methods and integrity in their specialism
- Attends Board meetings and declares interests
- May be invited onto the Protocol Review Board for specific protocols
- Named members form the rotation for the Protocol Review Board's stand-in chair when the CSO is conflicted
- Provides specialist input on N-of-1 design, statistical analysis and reporting standards (CENT and SPENT) and the SPIRIT and CONSORT guidelines

Decision rights

- Advisory only: members do not approve Health Explorations

Works closely with

- CSO and Science Advisory Board Chair
- Protocol Review Board, when invited

Notes and open points

- Title for all members: Science Advisor. "Bayesian analysis", "Methodology", "Emulative trials" and "Decision support" are specialisms, not job titles.
- Assumed that a subset of Science Advisory Board members will act as Chair.

Protocol Review Board: Non-scientist Member

Brings a lay and participant perspective to the review of every protocol.

Holder	To be confirmed
Board / team	Protocol Review Board (voting)
Required for	A valid decision (quorum)
Recommended	An external lay member, such as a patient or public representative

Key responsibilities

- Reviews each protocol from the participant's point of view: clarity of consent, burden, and how risk is explained
- Must be present for a Protocol Review Board decision to be valid
- Declares interests before each protocol is reviewed

Decision rights

- Voting member of the Protocol Review Board

Works closely with

- Protocol Review Board chair and members

Notes and open points

- One external lay person can fill both this seat and the unaffiliated seat.
- A lay person can be representative of individual needs, akin to a personal with lived experience.

Protocol Review Board: Unaffiliated Member

Provides independent challenge, so the Protocol Review Board is credible as a first-line ethics screen.

Holder	To be confirmed
Board / team	Protocol Review Board (voting)
Required for	A valid decision (quorum)
Condition	No employment, equity or consulting ties to Kind

Key responsibilities

- Gives independent challenge on each protocol
- Must be present for a Protocol Review Board decision to be valid
- Declares interests before each protocol is reviewed

Decision rights

- Voting member of the Protocol Review Board

Works closely with

- Protocol Review Board chair and members

Notes and open points

- Can be the same person as the non-scientist member.
- A minimum number of voting members (suggestion that this would be 4 or 5) is to be confirmed with BRANY.